



VCU

College of Engineering

CS-335: AI Agents for Bioinformatics

Team Contract

Prepared for
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By

Team Members

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Contents

Step 1: Get to Know Another	2
Step 2: Team Culture. Clarify the Group's Purpose and Culture Goals.	3
Step 3: Time Commitments, Meeting Structure, and Communication	4
Step 4: Determine Individual Roles and Responsibilities	5
Step 5: Agree to the above team contract	6

Step 1: Get to Know One Another. Gather Basic Information.

Task: This initial time together is important to form a strong team dynamic and get to know each other more as people outside of class time. Consider ways to develop positive working relationships with others, while remaining open and personal. Learn each other's strengths and discuss good/bad team experiences. This is also a good opportunity to start to better understand each other's communication and working styles.

<i>Team Member Name</i>	<i>Strengths each member bring to the group</i>	<i>Other Info</i>	<i>Contact Info</i>
<i>Carter Struck</i>	<i>Communicative, straight forward with issues, deadline conscious</i>	<i>Experience with python java react native, web scraping.</i>	<i>struckcm@vcu.edu</i>
<i>Mack Hicks</i>	<i>Eager to learn, work with others in incorporating each team members visions</i>	<i>Java, Python, Microsoft Power Apps, SQL</i>	<i>Hicksm5@vcu.edu</i>
<i>Sona James</i>	<i>Organization, time management, and problem-solving</i>	<i>I prefer working ahead of time so the team isn't rushed later on.</i>	<i>james9@vcu.edu</i>
<i>Ozi Jawad</i>	<i>Open to ideas, curious, communcative</i>	<i>Java, Python, R, sql, tableau</i>	<i>jawado@vcu.edu</i>

<i>Other Stakeholders</i>	<i>Notes</i>	<i>Contact Info</i>
<i>Tomasz Arodz</i>		<i>tarodz@vcu.edu</i>

Step 2: Team Culture. Clarify the Group's Purpose and Culture Goals.

Task: Discuss how each team member wants to be treated to encourage them to make valuable contributions to the group and how each team member would like to feel recognized for their efforts. Discuss how the team will foster an environment where each team member feels they are accountable for their actions and the way they contribute to the project. These are your Culture Goals (left column). How do the students demonstrate these culture goals? These are your Actions (middle column). Finally, how do students deviate from the team's culture goals? What are ways that other team members can notice when that culture goal is no longer being honored in team dynamics? These are your Warning Signs (right column).

Resources: More information and an example Team Culture can be found in the Biodesign Student Guide "Intentional Teamwork" page ([webpage](#) | [PDF](#))

<i>Culture Goals</i>	<i>Actions</i>	<i>Warning Signs</i>
<i>Attend meetings</i>	- <i>Set up reminders through a shared calendar or texting</i> - <i>Let other people know before hand if times don't work or unable to attend</i>	- <i>Student misses the first meeting, a warning is granted</i> - <i>Student misses meetings afterwards – the issue is brought up with the faculty advisor</i>
<i>Be open about delays in work progress</i>	- <i>Stay up to date with each other's project responsibilities</i> - <i>Set reasonable deadlines and note when an extension is needed</i> - <i>Be as open where you stand with the work as much as possible</i>	- <i>Student shows up for weekly meeting with no considerable work done</i>
<i>Be open to compromise and be respectful of others' decisions.</i>	- <i>Your idea did not get picked, don't crash out.</i>	- <i>Starts slacking after the idea didn't get picked.</i>

Step 3: Time Commitments, Meeting Structure, and Communication

Task: Discuss the anticipated time commitments for the group project. Consider the following questions (don't answer these questions in the box below):

- What are reasonable time commitments for everyone to invest in this project?
- What other activities and commitments do group members have in their lives?
- How will we communicate with each other?
- When will we meet as a team? Where will we meet? How Often?
- Who will run the meetings? Will there be an assigned team leader or scribe? Does that position rotate or will same person take on that role for the duration of the project?

Required: How often you will meet with your faculty advisor, where you will meet, and how the meetings will be conducted. Who arranges these meetings?

See examples below.

<i>Meeting Participants</i>	<i>Frequency Dates and Times / Locations</i>	<i>Meeting Goals Responsible Party</i>
<i>Students Only</i>	<i>On Discord as needed, most likely on the weekends</i>	<i>Actively work on project (Sona will document these meetings by taking photos of whiteboards, physical prototypes, etc, then post on Discord and update Capstone Report)</i>
<i>Students Only</i>	<i>Every Tuesday after class</i>	<i>Update group on day-to-day challenges and accomplishments</i>
<i>Students + Faculty advisor(Same for sponsor</i>	<i>Meet via zoom Wednesday or Monday every other week.</i>	<i>Update faculty advisor and get answers to our questions and share updates</i>

Step 4: Determine Individual Roles and Responsibilities

Task: As part of the Capstone Team experience, each member will take on a leadership role, *in addition to* contributing to the overall weekly action items for the project. Some common leadership roles for Capstone projects are listed below. Other roles may be assigned with approval of your faculty advisor as deemed fit for the project. For the entirety of the project, you should communicate progress to your advisor specifically with regard to your role.

- **Before meeting with your team**, take some time to ask yourself: what is my “natural” role in this group (strengths)? How can I use this experience to help me grow and develop more?
- **As a group**, discuss the various tasks needed for the project and role preferences. Then assign roles in the table on the next page. Try to create a team dynamic that is fair and equitable, while promoting the strengths of each member.

Communication Leaders

Suggested: Assign a team member to be the primary contact for the client/sponsor. This person will schedule meetings, send updates, and ensure deliverables are met.

Suggested: Assign a team member to be the primary contact for faculty advisor. This person will schedule meetings, send updates, and ensure deliverables are met.

Common Leadership Roles for Capstone

1. **Project Manager:** Manages all tasks; develops overall schedule for project; writes agendas and runs meetings; reviews and monitors individual action items; creates an environment where team members are respected, take risks and feel safe expressing their ideas.
2. **Logistics Manager:** coordinates all internal and external interactions; lead in establishing contact within and outside of organization, following up on communication of commitments, obtaining information for the team; documents meeting minutes; manages facility and resource usage.
3. **Financial Manager:** researches/benchmarks technical purchases and acquisitions; conducts pricing analysis and budget justifications on proposed purchases; carries out team purchase requests; monitors team budget.
4. **Systems Engineer:** analyzes Client initial design specification and leads establishment of product specifications; monitors, coordinates and manages integration of sub-systems in the prototype; develops and recommends system architecture and manages product interfaces.
5. **Test Engineer:** oversees experimental design, test plan, procedures and data analysis; acquires data acquisition equipment and any necessary software; establishes test protocols and schedules; oversees statistical analysis of results; leads presentation of experimental finding and resulting recommendations.
6. **Manufacturing Engineer:** coordinates all fabrication required to meet final prototype requirements; oversees that all engineering drawings meet the requirements of machine shop or vendor; reviews designs to ensure design for manufacturing; determines realistic timing for fabrication and quality; develops schedule for all manufacturing.

<i>Team Member</i>	<i>Role(s)</i>	<i>Responsibilities</i>
Mack Hicks	System Engineer	Introducing design ideas Overseeing the specifications of the project being met
Ozi Jawad	Logistics Manager	Communicates with advisor Coordinates internal and external interactions Obtains information for the team Manage resource usage
Carter Struck	Project manager	Manages all tasks; develops overall schedule for project; writes agendas and runs meetings; reviews and monitors individual action items; creates an environment where team members are respected, take risks and feel safe expressing their ideas. Decider in group differences.
Sona James	Documentation Manager	Documents meeting minutes - key points and decisions made during the meeting. Oversees statistical analysis Creates and maintains task lists/Organizes workspace

Step 5: Agree to the above team contract

Team Member: Ozi Jawad

Signature: Ozi Jawad

Team Member: Mack Hicks

Signature: Mack Hicks

Team Member: Sona James

Signature: Sona James

Team Member: Carter Struck

Signature: Carter Struck